

Ivonne Benites Rodriguez

Cybersecurity Professional | AppSec & GRC

CONTACT

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github.com/IvonneBenitesRodriguez
[Portfolio \(web\)](#)

EDUCATION & CERTS

MSc Cybersecurity Arden University,
Berlin *Merit · Thesis: Distinction*
Jr. Penetration Tester Path
TryHackMe *Completed 2026*
Governance & Regulation TryHackMe
Room *Completed 2026*
Full Stack Web Development
Microverse *1,300+ hrs*
BSc Marketing UPC, Lima *2015*

GRC & COMPLIANCE

ISO 27001 · NIST CSF · NIS2
GDPR / DSGVO
Risk Assessment · Gap Analysis
Audit Support · Policy Writing
Incident Response

APPSEC & TOOLS

OWASP Top 10 · Threat Modeling
(STRIDE)
Vulnerability Assessment
Burp Suite · Nmap · Metasploit
Ruby on Rails · JavaScript ·
PostgreSQL
Linux · Bash · Git

LANGUAGES

Spanish Native
English C1 — Professional
German B2 (Target: C1)
Italian C1 — Fluent
French Advanced
Japanese JLPT N4

PROFILE

Cybersecurity professional with an MSc in Cybersecurity (Merit, Thesis: Distinction), eager to learn and deeply committed to growing in Application Security and GRC. Hands-on experience with penetration testing, threat modeling (STRIDE), and secure software development, complemented by the TryHackMe Junior Penetration Tester Path and the Governance & Regulation room. Volunteering at OWASP Global AppSec Conference Vienna 2026.

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

MSc Thesis — Distinction

“Enhancing Web Application Security: A Comprehensive Analysis of Penetration Testing Stages, Tools, and Best Practices in the Financial Sector”

Co-Author — Springer Journal (Under Review)

“Penetration Testing: A Comprehensive Guide for Cybersecurity Practitioners” — Journal of Computer Virology and Hacking Techniques, submitted October 2025.

PROJECTS

Happy Apple Online Store — Full-Stack Security Portfolio Project 2026

- Built a Ruby on Rails 8.1 e-commerce MVP using strict TDD (RSpec), achieving a clean Brakeman scan (0 warnings) and implementing IDOR protection on the orders controller
- Modeled application threats with OWASP Threat Dragon (STRIDE) across 18 threats and 5 system components; documented GDPR and PCI-DSS compliance considerations
- Deployed live on Railway with PostgreSQL, featuring a Turbo Streams-powered cart and checkout flow

[Live Demo](#)

Ruby on Rails · RSpec/TDD · Brakeman · OWASP Threat Dragon · STRIDE · PostgreSQL · Railway

Web Application Security Project — Live in Production 2026

- Built and operate a secure full-stack application (Rails 8.1 REST API, PostgreSQL on Railway; JavaScript frontend on GitHub Pages)
- Implemented BCrypt authentication, Rack::Attack rate limiting against brute-force activity, and XSS input sanitization
- Test-driven development (TDD) with RSpec

[Live](#) | [GitHub](#)

EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Analyst & GRC Researcher 2024 – 2026

Independent Research / MSc Project — Berlin, Germany

- Conducted vulnerability assessments and gap analyses applying OWASP Top 10, NIST CSF, ISO 27001 and NIS2 with structured remediation documentation
- Completed TryHackMe Jr. Penetration Tester Path and Governance & Regulation room — practical skills in SQL injection, Burp Suite, Metasploit and privilege escalation
- Applied GDPR/DSGVO compliance frameworks — access controls, data minimisation, incident documentation

IT Security & Compliance Manager 2018 – Present

Casa Yllika — Remote from Berlin, Germany

- Configured Google Cloud OAuth 2.0, DKIM/SPF/DMARC, WordPress security hardening and GDPR-compliant data handling policies
- Managed access controls, credential lifecycle and security audits for production infrastructure

Web Developer Intern Sep – Nov 2024

TREAGE — Healthcare Tech Startup, Berlin (Hybrid)

- Built React.js/MUI components with secure REST API integrations in a regulated healthcare environment

COMMUNITY & VOLUNTEERING

- Volunteer, OWASP Global AppSec Conference Vienna 2026 — Web Application Security